

Project 2: ManiFolio

Domain: Vertical SaaS / Operations tool for SMBs

Industry: Beauty and personal care services

Prepared by:

Michelle Tran

Role Targeted:

Business Analyst | Product/ System Analyst | Product Owner

Business Requirement Document and Product Architecture

This document is presented the end-to-end build ManiFolio – an AI-assisted web app for nail salons. The underlying project was designed and built solo, using Claude, Gemini API, Supabase, and Vercel

1. Executive Summary

Independent nail salons in France rely on smartphone camera rolls and social media accounts to store photos of completed nail designs. These photos are the most valuable sales tool – what convinces a walk-in customer to book a specific design – yet they are unorganized, mixed in with personal photos and searchable only by memory.

It creates a hidden dependency: staff cannot retrieve a relevant past design quickly, and the salon owner is pulled away from her own client to help search for a photo on someone else's phone.

ManiFolio addresses this by giving each salon a shared, *tagged photo library – with AI-assisted color tagging to remove the manual data-entry burden* – that any staff member can search and show to a customer under 10 seconds.

2. Business Context

2.1. Business scenario (representative persona)

Anna owns a nail salon in France with 4 staff members and also serves her own client daily

2.2. Business need

Staff need a way to quickly build and retrieve a portfolio of real photos from past appointments, so they can confidently advise new customers without interrupting the owner

2.3. Root cause

Photos currently live inside a personal camera roll with no organizing context. Every customer consultation starts from 0, which slows down design selection and increases staff dependence on the owner – precisely when she is busiest with her own clients

2.4. Current solution and its limits

Solution	Limits
Camera roll	Default storage tool, shared with personal photos, searched by scrolling and relying on memory – fingers scroll, eyes roll
Social platform (IG, FB, Tiktok)	Secondary visual archive, but retrieval still depends on manual scrolling and memory of where a photo was posted
Face-off consultation	2 situations occur: + A reference design from customer that the salon has never done before -> new evidence that should be added + A rough idea and staff must propose options -> slow retrieval and reliance on individual staff skill create the most friction

2.5. Business opportunity

A shared, searchable library – organized automatically by color via AI/complexity and manually by occasion – would let any staff close a design decision independently, reducing bottlenecks on the owner and improving the consistency of the customer experience.

3. Approach

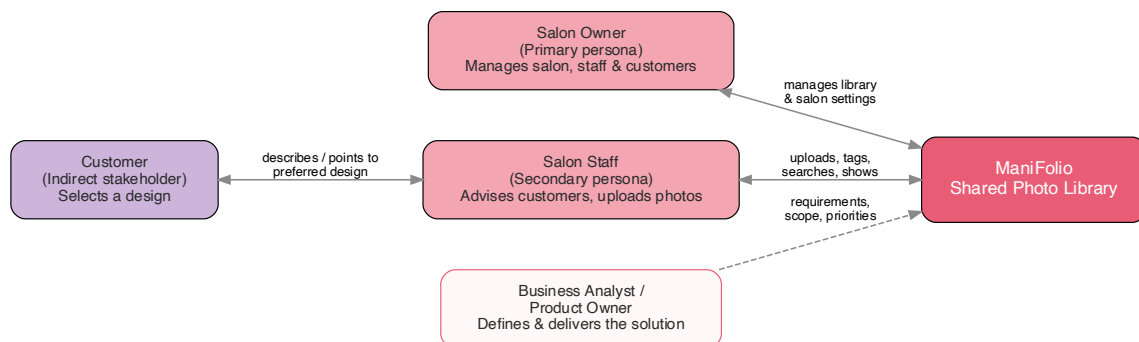
- Business Discovery: Owner interviews, stylist shadowing, customer journey mapping, As-Is, To-Be workflows, pain point analysis

- Photo Library Assessment: Existing photo collection review, tagging practices, metadata analysis, duplicate & quality assessment
- AI Solution Design: AI-assisted color tagging, keyword search, recommendation logic, search optimization
- Product Definition: User story mapping, MVP prioritization, backlog creation, roadmap planning, usability requirements
- Validation & Adoption: Salon pilot testing, search accuracy evaluation, stylist feedback analysis, adoption monitoring, continuous product improvement

4. Business Objectives

Objective	Target
Reduce time to find a suitable design	~ 10 seconds via AI color detection + manual filters
Reduce time to file photos after an appointment	~ 2 minutes per 10 photos, via automated color tagging
Increase staff self-sufficiency	70% of staff-customer design decisions closed without owner involvement
Build a daily upload habit	Minimum 10 new photos added per operating day
Remove adoption friction	Full core flow usable on mobile browser, no install; onboarding under 5 minutes
Maintain AI tagging quality	AI color tags kept without override in over 80% of cases

5. Stakeholder



6. Customer Journey

Stage	Customer Goal	Current Experience (As-Is)	Pain Points	Future Experience (To-Be)	Opportunity
1. Customer Consultation Begins	Explain desired nail design	Customer shows an inspiration photo or describes colors, occasion, or style	Many customers have only vague ideas; stylists struggle to visualize options	Stylist quickly filters the shared photo library by color, occasion, or complexity to present relevant examples	Faster consultation and higher customer confidence
2. Finding Inspiration	Show examples that match customer preferences	Owner or employee scrolls through phone gallery or social media, relying on memory	Photos are mixed with personal images; searching takes several minutes; depends on owner's memory	AI-powered search returns matching portfolio photos within 10 seconds	Reduce search time and dependency on memory
3. Design Decision	Agree on the final nail design	Customer compares random photos found during scrolling	Limited examples, inconsistent recommendations, owner often needs to assist	Customer reviews organized real salon work with consistent tags and chooses confidently	Increase employee autonomy and consultation quality
4. Nail Service	Deliver the chosen design	Stylist performs the service	No structured way to connect finished work back to knowledge base	Service is completed using agreed reference photos	Better expectation alignment
5. Portfolio Update	Save today's work for future consultations	Photos remain in personal camera roll or social media	Manual organization is time-consuming; photos are rarely categorized	Employee uploads photos, AI detects colors automatically, user confirms tags in about 2 minutes	Build a continuously growing knowledge library

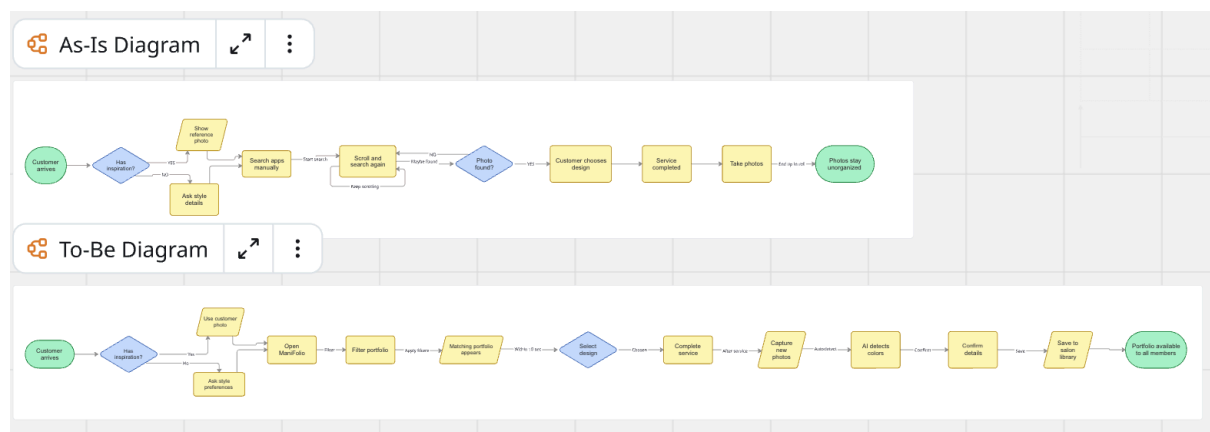
Stage	Customer Goal	Current Experience (As-Is)	Pain Points	Future Experience (To-Be)	Opportunity
6. Future Consultation	Reuse previous successful designs	Search starts from scratch every time	Knowledge is not shared across staff	Entire team accesses the same searchable portfolio	Institutional knowledge instead of personal memory

7. Discovery summary

- Methods: Interview, Observation, Survey

As-Is	To-Be
5+ minutes scrolling	<10 seconds AI-assisted search
Memory-based recommendations	Searchable shared knowledge
Owner-dependent consultation	Employee self-service
Photos stored individually	Centralized salon portfolio
Manual organization	AI-assisted tagging
Camera Roll as storage	Knowledge library for customer consultation

AS-IS VS TO-BE workflow



8. Scope – Version 1

- Direct-from-camera capture and batch import from camera roll (up to 50 photos/batch)
- Hybrid AI + manual color tagging and Complexity (AI suggests + staff confirms/corrects) + manual Occasion tagging
- Shared salon photo library with color, occasion, and complexity filtering, basic keyword search

- Multi-user access with 2 roles: Owner (full rights) and Staff (upload, use, limited edit rights)
- Link-based staff invitation with no app install required
- No-signup “Try Mode” to demonstrate AI tagging before any commitment

9. Out of Scope

Feature	Reason
AI auto-tagging of Occasion	Depends on the personal style and definition
Semantic search	Requires a larger volume of real photo data
Direct social sharing	Existing habits are already adequate, not a core pain point
AI matching against real-time availability	Requires accurate color detection to mature first; not yet demanded at this scale
“Similar design” AI recommendations	Depends on data volume only available
Daily activity notification per staff	Deferred
Duplicate photo detection	Requires a larger library and further AI training

10. Business Requirements

Each requirement below reflects a stakeholder need identified through the problem analysis in Section 2, prioritized using MoSCoW.

ID	Business Requirement	Business Rule	Priority
BR-01	Owners and staff can create an account with minimal friction (salon name, name, role only)	No email or verification required to begin; user proceeds directly into the upload flow with no empty dashboard	Must-have
BR-02	A "Try Mode" lets a prospective user test AI tagging on their own photos before committing	Limited to 5 photos, no account required; photos carry forward into full registration if the user proceeds	Must-have
BR-03	Users can complete full salon registration after trying the product	Requires salon address, phone, email, and a unique Salon Code; the 5 trial photos are retained	Must-have

ID	Business Requirement	Business Rule	Priority
BR-04	Staff and owners can capture or import photos in batches	Direct in-app camera capture, or camera-roll import up to 50 photos per batch	Must-have
BR-05	The system suggests colors for each photo automatically	AI-suggested colors must be confirmed or corrected by the user; suggestions below a confidence threshold are flagged for review	Must-have
BR-06	Users manually classify each photo by Occasion and Complexity	Occasion offers presets plus the ability to add custom values; Complexity is a forced choice of Simple / Medium / Complex	Must-have
BR-07	All confirmed photos are saved to one shared salon library	Library updates are visible to all salon users in real time	Must-have
BR-08	Users can filter and search the shared library	Filtering by color, occasion, and complexity updates results in real time without a page reload; basic keyword search is supported	Must-have (filter) / Should-have (keyword search)
BR-09	Staff can present a selected photo to a customer in a distraction-free view	Full-screen display with pinch-to-zoom and left/right swipe between results	Must-have
BR-10	Owners can invite staff without requiring an app install	Invitation is a shareable link/QR code with a 24-hour expiry; staff join directly from a mobile browser	Must-have
BR-11	Staff can regain access after logging out without needing an OTP or password	Re-entry uses phone number plus Salon Code, matched against the salon's staff record	Must-have
BR-12	Owners can regain access after logging out without needing an OTP or password	Re-entry uses Salon Code plus phone number, matched against the salon's owner record	Must-have
BR-13	Staff may correct their own photo's tags exactly once	After a staff edit is saved, the photo's tags are locked and further changes require the owner	Must-have
BR-14	Owners have unrestricted management rights over the shared library	Owners can edit any photo's tags at any time, with no edit limit	Must-have
BR-15	Owners can see which photos are missing required tagging information	Photos missing Occasion or Complexity are visibly flagged in the library view	Must-have
BR-16	Owners can manage salon information and staff visibility in one place	A single settings area covers salon details, the Salon Code, a read-only staff list, and staff invitation	Must-have

11. Business KPIs

Metric	Target	Measured
Time from opening filters to selecting a photo	< 10 seconds	Time between filter-opened and image-selected events
Time to complete one upload + tagging cycle	< 2 minutes	Time between upload-start and save-confirm events
Share of staff sessions with no concurrent owner session	>70% after 30 days	Session logs by role
New photos uploaded per operating day	From 10 photos/day	Upload count by date
Time from invitation received to first productive action	< 5 minutes	Time between invite-accepted and first-filter (or first save)
Share of AI color tags kept without override	>80%	Tag-confirmed vs. tag-overridden events
Share of salons still uploading after 14 days	>60%	Cohort upload rate

12. Risks & Mitifations

Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation
AI color detection not accurate	High	Medium	Allow manual override + preset colors
Users do not form upload habit	High	High	Prompt “upload after each session” + reduce friction to <30s
Gemini 2.5 Flash rate limit hit	Medium	Low (beta)	Free tier 1500 req/day sufficient for < 10 salons. Exponential backoff retry. Fallback to manual_tag_required
Gemini API unavailable/error	Medium	Low	Retry max 2x -> fallback to mamnual tag. User never blocked - can always tag manually
Staff re-entry friction	Medium	Medium	Salon Code + Phone (no OTP) minimizes friction. Tutorial covers re-entry. Owner can share code via WhatsApp/Zalo
Staff upload quality low (blurry)	Medium	Medium	AI returns warning: “blurry”. Review screen flags photo. Owner can delete/hide in V2

